

ArchiMate cheat sheet — every element, by layer and aspect

All 60 elements of ArchiMate® 3.2 in one grid, placed by the two questions that decide where an element belongs.

THE FRAMEWORK

	ACTIVE STRUCTURE who or what does it	BEHAVIOUR what is done	PASSIVE STRUCTURE what it is done to
Motivation why — its own aspect	Stakeholder · Driver · Assessment · Goal · Outcome · Principle · Requirement · Constraint · Meaning · Value		
Strategy what we must be able to do	Resource	Capability · Value Stream · Course of Action	—
Business what the organisation does for its customers	Business Actor · Business Role · Business Collaboration · Business Interface	Business Process · Business Function · Business Interaction · Business Event · Business Service	Business Object · Contract · Representation · Product †
Application what software does for the business	Application Component · Application Collaboration · Application Interface	Application Function · Application Interaction · Application Process · Application Event · Application Service	Data Object
Technology what infrastructure does for software	Node · Device · System Software · Technology Collaboration · Technology Interface · Path · Communication Network	Technology Function · Technology Process · Technology Interaction · Technology Event · Technology Service	Artifact
Physical part of Technology, not a layer of its own	Equipment · Facility · Distribution Network	— <i>uses Technology behaviour</i>	Material
Implementation & Migration how we get there	—	Work Package · Implementation Event	Deliverable · Plateau ‡ · Gap ‡
Composite no layer of their own	Grouping — anything that belongs together · Location — where elements sit or behaviour happens		

† **Product** is **composite**, not passive structure: it aggregates services and passive elements across layers, under a contract. Most cheat sheets file it wrongly. ‡ **Plateau** aggregates core elements as they stand at one point in time; **Gap** states the difference between two plateaus.

PLACING AN ELEMENT — TWO QUESTIONS

1. Whom does it serve? That is the layer. Technology serves applications, applications serve the business, the business serves its customers. **2. What kind of thing is it?** Active structure does something, behaviour is what is done, passive structure is what it is done to.

INTERNAL OR EXTERNAL — THE PAIR PEOPLE MISS

Every layer repeats the same pair. A **Service** is the outward face of **behaviour** — what others may use. An **Interface** is the outward face of **active structure** — where they reach it. Everything else in the layer is internal, and no one outside should depend on it.

READING THE NOTATION

Colour is convention, not specification — yellow business, blue application, green technology, purple motivation, tan strategy, pink implementation. The small **icon in the top-right** corner of a box carries the actual element type; a rounded box is behaviour, a square one is structure.

RELATIONSHIPS

11 + junction

STRUCTURAL — STATIC COHERENCE

- Composition**
the part cannot exist without the whole
- Aggregation**
groups parts that can exist alone
- Assignment**
who performs it, where it runs
- Realization**
the concrete one delivers the abstract one
- DEPENDENCY — ONE NEEDS ANOTHER**
- Serving**
provides its functionality to another
- Access**
reads, writes or deletes a passive element
- Influence**
affects a motivation element, for or against
- Association**
a link the language has no word for

DYNAMIC — SOMETHING MOVES

- Triggering**
this then that — order in time
- Flow**
something is transferred — data, money, goods

OTHER & CONNECTOR

- Specialization**
is a particular kind of
- Junction**
and / or — joins relationships of one type

The derivation rule — the one worth memorising

A chain of relationships pointing the same way can be replaced by the **weakest link in the chain**. That is how a diagram stays readable when you zoom out.
composition > aggregation > assignment > realization > serving > access > influence > association

THREE PAIRS THAT GET CONFUSED

Assignment vs realization. Assignment allocates a performer — an actor *does* a process. Realization says something concrete delivers something abstract — a process *provides* a service.
Serving vs flow. Serving is a standing offer: it is available to you. Flow is one actual transfer during one run.
Composition vs aggregation. A composed part dies with its whole and has exactly one whole. An aggregated part survives on its own and may belong to several.